



Reclaim your Time with TimeOS

Overview

Think of your time like the operating system on a computer or mobile phone. You can only run so much in a day before the system slows down or the day ends. This is what I call Time Operating System, or **TimeOS**, a mental model for the total capacity of your time and attention during your waking hours. For this activity, assume your system is already full, since most of us fill our days with something.

There are 3 key components that make up your time within **TimeOS**:

System - is your chosen or non-negotiable to maintain your lifestyle that make up a large chunk of your time. These are not things to survive that are universal in all of us like eating and sleeping. Think family, job/career, other ongoing responsibilities specific to you.

Apps - fill in majority of the remaining time/attention available either with literal apps like social media, Netflix, games, or other things you've "installed" over time: hobbies, habits, side projects, recurring tasks, or distractions that may or may not serve you.

Hidden Processes - are recurring thoughts or actions that quietly take up your attention in the background.

Our focus for this activity is on what apps are running and what would you swap out or uninstall to free time for what matters more to you? This isn't pressure to act now. You can simply do this activity and come back to it when you're ready to activate on your own time.

TimeOS



■
System
(Core responsibilities)

■
Apps
(Non-essential activities)

■
Hidden Processes
(Reoccurring themes)

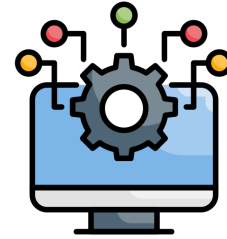


TimeOS Audit

Use the worksheet to run a quick audit of your current system:

Step 1: List your system – Your non-negotiable commitments that keep your lifestyle running. Example: Family, Job/Career, etc.. Keep it high-level; details are optional.

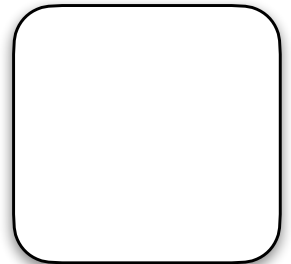
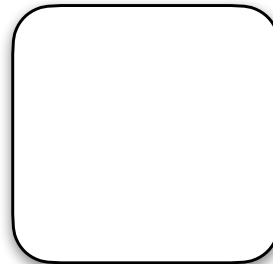
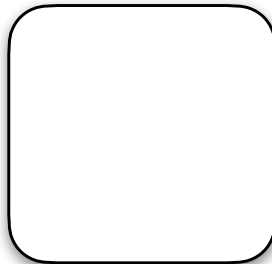
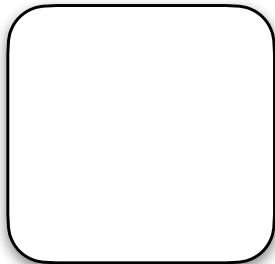
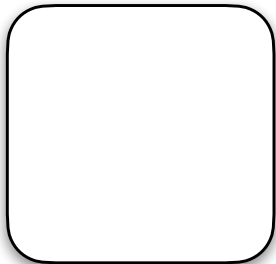
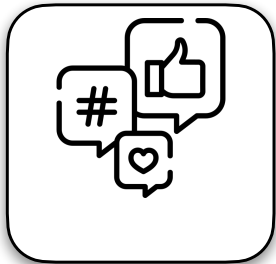
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Step 2: Identify your top 5–10 apps: These are the biggest time-consumers outside of my system. I've given you some examples below, just fill in the blank below the app icon within the square or use the blank app squares I've provided.

Here are a few AI generated non-essential apps that could be lingering for us, some of them certainly rang a bell for me!

- **Casual shopping**
- **Over-socializing**
- **Unstructured hobby time without progress**
- **Routine errands done inefficiently** (grocery trips every other day instead of batching)
- **Low-value meetings or calls**
- **Excessive news scrolling**
- **Over-researching**

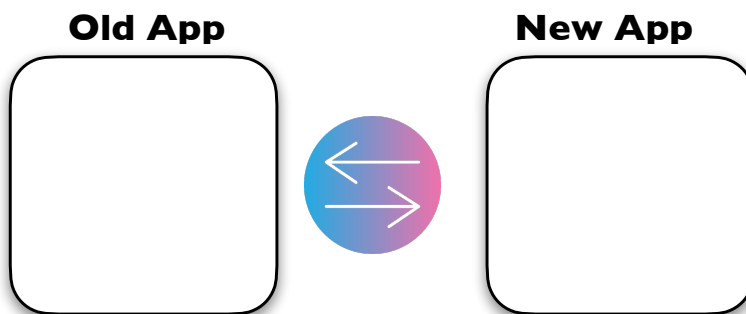




Step 3: Spot the hidden processes: Recurring thoughts or small actions that quietly take attention (e.g., repeated worries, unnecessary errands, mental to-do's). Think of the iceberg analogy. What's beneath the surface or what hidden processes are coming to mind for you?



Step 4: Decide if you want to swap out an app: Pick one “app” to downgrade or uninstall to make space for something you want more. If you’ve decided to swap an app, briefly explain for your future self why and what your plan is to swap the app out. Gradual, cold turkey, any new habits required, etc?



Step 5: (Optional): System Upgrade: Promote one meaningful activity from “app” to **system** status when ready. Examples of what that might look like:

- **Minimum viable cadence** (e.g., lift 3×/week, write 30 min M–F)
- **Success criteria** for keeping it in the system
- **Sunset rule** if it no longer serves you



This was cool, but what's the point of all this? Well if want something, whatever that thing is for you, you have to commit time to work towards it. This concept makes it easy to find what you can swap out to make time, not to mention to spot any hidden processes to be mindful of.



Add Modules into your TimeOS with Proven Systems From These Great Books

Freeing up some time is one thing, but being productive with that time is a whole other topic that is well established and covered by some of these books. Choose one that fits your style or a use case you're looking for, and let it guide how you use the time you've unlocked.

- **Getting Things Done** – Professional workflow, project tracking
- **The ONE Thing** – Goal clarity, business focus
- **Better Than Before** – Weight loss habits, dating confidence
- **Deep Work** – Skill learning, distraction control
- **Atomic Habits** – Daily exercise, consistent routines
- **The 7 Habits of Highly Effective People** – Relationship building, life balance



GenAI Activity: Drop your completed doc into ChatGPT or AI tool

Want extra clarity? Bring in a modern tool.

Once you've dropped your completed doc into your AI tool of choice, ask for an analysis along with 5 follow-up questions that leads to 5 suggestions.



Want More Like This?

I also share no-fluff, high-level modern personal growth insights like this once a month.

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And always...follow your compass

Bonus Activity

Our percentage of system, apps, and hidden process is going to be different for us all. Above I assumed averages across all 3 for you. Here is your opportunity to customize it to your reality.

Customizable TimeOS



System

(Core responsibilities)



Apps

(Non-essential activities)



Hidden Processes

(Reoccurring themes)



Free Time

(Simple)

Define your own percentage for each category and color code